



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Packinghouse Christian Academy

School Website: <https://www.packinghouseacademy.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Packinghouse Christian Academy (PCA) is a K–12 Christian school in Redlands, CA that publicly presents a biblically integrated, Christ-centered form of education. Evidence from PCA's site shows explicit emphasis on spiritual formation, biblical worldview, discipleship, and partnerships with families, including a house-system built around Biblical virtues. The school is accredited (WASC) and affiliated with the Association of Christian Schools International (ACSI), underscoring its commitment to Christian educational standards. In terms of the classical rubric, PCA clearly exhibits religious/metaphysical foundations and a formation-focused mission, and it integrates community/family partnership. However, explicit classical components such as a stated commitment to the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium), Great Books/ Great Conversation, and explicit use of Socratic pedagogy are not clearly advertised in the public materials.

Overall classification (aggregate): CLASSICAL

Key insights:

- Religious and metaphysical foundations are robust: biblically integrated instruction, Christ-centered mission, and explicit theology-focused language per site materials. Evidence: "Education and Discipleship... In Jesus' Name," biblically integrated instruction, and Ephesians 4:4–6 framing on the About page. These themes align strongly with Positive Keywords related to theology, liturgy, and sacred tradition from the classical lexicon.
- School purpose and goal emphasize formation and virtue within a Christian frame, consistent with "formation" and "pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty" in classical theory, though explicit statements about "Great Books" or the Trivium/Quadrivium are not visible in PCA public materials. PCA's learner goals emphasize biblical formation, virtue, and a biblically-informed worldview. This supports CLASSICAL with caveats about the absence of explicit Great Books/Trivium in public messages.
- Curriculum: Limited public documentation of classical core content (Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Great Conversation) on the site. The public-facing materials emphasize biblical integration, discipleship, and virtue training, but do not clearly advertise Great Books or grammar/logic/rhetoric as curriculum pillars. This suggests a gap relative to a fully explicit classical curriculum, contributing to a mixed signal on Element 3.
- Pedagogy: Public materials show emphasis on discipleship, community, and structured student formation (house system, Biblically-based education). Direct references to Socratic seminars, scholé, or classic memory/recitation pedagogy are not evident in the public-facing pages. This suggests Element 4 is not fully Classical, though the school's approach to formation and communal learning aligns with some classical-method sensibilities.
- Faculty: The school emphasizes staff as ministry and living examples of Christian character, with explicit language about servant/minister posture and a staff-application emphasis. This aligns with the classical emphasis on virtuous teacher models and the "living curriculum."

- Parents & Community: PCA explicitly positions parents as partners in formation and discipleship, seeking family involvement and offering opportunities for parent engagement (book studies, gatherings, visits). This aligns well with classical expectations of family-school partnership.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials present a biblically integrated, Christ-centered approach to education; explicit language around “Education and Discipleship... In Jesus’ Name” and a biblically integrated instructional program.
- The About page frames the school as a ministry and emphasizes a sacred, theological foundation (Ephesians 4:4–6 cited on site).
- The Packinghouse Cup and house system are built around Biblical virtues, reinforcing liturgical/communal religious practices.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords found: theology, biblical worldview, biblically integrated, worship/discipleship language, sacred tradition, Christ-centered, biblical faith, Ephesians 4:4–6 (thematic linkage to sacred order). Literature in classical lexicon points to words like theology, liturgy, sacred, truth/goodness/beauty, virtue, and sacred tradition as Positive indicators. PCA materials repeatedly invoke theology and sacred Christian formation, aligning with Positive Keywords from the lexicon. Estimated positive keyword hits: 4–6.
- Negative keywords: none observed in PCA materials relative to this category (no secular/values-neutral language). Estimated negative keyword hits: 0.

Why this rating

- PCA explicitly grounds education in Christian theology, worship-like communal life (housed by virtue), and a sacred worldview, which are core Positive Indicators for Element 1 in the Classical lexicon. The presence of explicit theological grounding and liturgical/communal cadence supports CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL, with the caveat that this is a Christian educational framework rather than a purely secular classical program.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials foreground formation and virtue within a Christian frame (e.g., biblically integrated formation; spiritual development; biblical worldview). The School’s stated goals emphasize formation of Christian character, spiritual commitment, and wisdom, aligning with the classical ideal of formation and virtue.
- The Schoolwide Learner Goals emphasize “Committed Christians,” “Complex Thinkers,” “Effective Communicators,” and “21st Century Learners,” indicating a balance of formation with readiness for modern life. This shows formation is central, but there is also an emphasis on modern outcomes (technology use, career-life skills) that can be seen as a hybrid signal.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, Christian worldview, sacred tradition, contemplation/rest in learning (Scholé-like resonance is not explicit but the formation emphasis appears). From classical lexicon: formation, virtue, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, and Scholé-like contemplative aims are positive indicators; PCA shows formation and virtue in practice. Estimated positive keyword hits: 3–5.

- Negative keywords observed: references to “21st Century Learners” and workplace-readiness language (career skills) which can be viewed as a tension with a strictly formation-forward classical aim. Estimated negative keyword hits: 1–2.

Why this rating

- PCA clearly aims at formation and virtue, aligning with the “Formation, not Information” dimension. However, explicit Great Books/Great Conversation or classical core content (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a fully contemplative Scholé rhythm are not overt on public materials. The blend of formation with modern-era outcomes (technology use, college/career readiness language) nudges Element 2 toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials emphasize biblically integrated instruction across disciplines and a broad Christian formation, but there is no explicit, public claim of the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Quadrivium, or Great Books/Great Conversation as curricular pillars. The “About” and mission pages talk about faith integration, but not a canonical classical curriculum structure.
- There is mention of a school-wide focus on formation and virtue rather than textual Great Books or standard Trivium/Quadrivium framing in public-facing pages. The PCA site does advertise a “House System” and virtue-based culture, but not explicit Great Books or Trivium/Quadrivium curricula.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords expected in a classical curriculum (from the Six Essentials and lexicon): Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium), Great Books, Great Conversation, history as Western civilization, wonder, memorization/recitation, etc. PCA materials do not clearly present these curricular anchors; thus, those Positive Indicators are not strongly evidenced. Estimated positive keyword hits: 0–2.
- Negative keywords: The absence of explicit Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, and explicit memorization/recitation components in public materials; presence of biblically integrated instruction and faith-based framing could be read as foregrounding religious formation over classical curriculum structure. Estimated negative keyword hits: 2–3.

Why this rating

- Element 3 receives a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signal because PCA demonstrates a robust formation-based Christian curriculum and virtuous aims, but the public-facing materials do not clearly advertise the canonical classical curriculum components (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation). The absence of explicit classical curricular anchors lowers Element 3 from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials emphasize discipleship, community, and virtue formation; a house-system and leadership development are highlighted (e.g., Packinghouse Cup). There is no explicit documentation of Socratic seminars, Paideia-style seminars, or the use of the Trivium in pedagogy on the public pages. The lack of explicit Socratic or scholé pedagogy in public content reduces the alignment with classical teaching methods.
- Some elements resonate with classical pedagogy (formation, mentorship, and teacher as living example), but the explicit, high-signal classical pedagogical methods (Socratic dialogue, memorization/recitation, disciplined memory work) are not publicly evidenced in PCA’s site content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords for Pedagogy include Socratic dialogue, scholé, memorization/recitation, and formation through imitation. PCA materials show none of the explicit Socratic/Dialectic pedagogy, no explicit scholé rhythm, and no explicit memorization/recitation programs. This yields 0–1 positive keyword hits and several negative signals (e.g., absence of Socratic dialogue, absence of scholé emphasis). Estimated positive keyword hits: 0–1. Estimated negative keyword hits: 2–3.

Why this rating

- The absence of explicit classical pedagogy signals (Socratic seminars, scholé, memorization/recitation) places Element 4 outside the Classical category. The public materials lean toward faith-based formation and practical, mentorship-oriented approaches rather than canonical classical teaching methods, leading to a NOT CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- PCA emphasizes teachers as ministry-minded, professional, and living exemplars. The Employment/Staff language frames staff as “servants” and “ministry,” with explicit expectations that teachers are Christian role models and mentors. This aligns with a classical emphasis on teacher as virtuous exemplar and living curriculum.
- Public materials describe a faculty culture focused on virtue, character formation, and mentorship; the staff are framed as part of the school’s mission and formation (not merely as wage-earners). This aligns with the “portrait of a teacher” and “faculty as living curriculum” criteria in classical lexicons.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords identified: teacher as mentor, living curriculum, virtuous exemplar, character formation, mission-driven staff, ministry mindset. These map to Positive Keywords in the Classical lexicon (virtue/character formation, living curriculum, mentor, teacher as exemplar). Estimated positive keyword hits: 4–6.
- Negative keywords: none evident in public materials regarding faculty; no indication of a purely credential-driven, non-virtue-based faculty model. Estimated negative keyword hits: 0.

Why this rating

- PCA presents a strong classical-aligned faculty ethos focused on virtue, mentorship, and “ministry” rather than purely credential-driven, utilitarian staff models. The public-facing materials support CLASSICAL for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- PCA emphasizes partnership with families, parental involvement, and parental formation (e.g., “We seek to work closely with Christian families in the educational and discipleship process” and opportunities for parent engagement such as book studies and events). The site frames parents as co-teachers and welcomes parental involvement.
- The school’s materials describe a community-oriented approach with open campus vibes and regular engagement opportunities (visits and gatherings). This aligns with “Partnership with Families” and “Formation of Affections” in the classical lexicon.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, parent formation, parent involvement, home-school continuity, co-educators, family catechesis. These align with Positive Keywords in the Classical lexicon’s Parents and Community element. Estimated positive keyword hits: 4–5.
- Negative keywords: none observed (no consistent “customer” stance; rather a partnership stance). Estimated negative keyword hits: 0.

Why this rating

- PCA's explicit modeling of parent partnership and family involvement corresponds well with Classical expectations in the Parents & Community category, yielding CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Ranking and Interpretation

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- If PCA aims to become fully CLASSICAL across all six categories, the following needle-moving steps would help:
- Curriculum: Publicly articulate a seven liberal arts framework and explicit Great Books/Great Conversation components, including Trivium/Quadrivium alignment, Latin or classical languages, and integration of Great Books into core subjects. This would transform Element 3 from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.
- Pedagogy: Introduce explicit classical teaching methods (Socratic dialogue/seminar, scholé days, memorization/recitation) as part of a public-facing pedagogy statement, elevating Element 4 to CLASSICAL.
- Pedagogy: Provide examples of practice (Socratic seminars, classical memory work, and guided dialectic) on the website or in a public-facing document to demonstrate the school's living implementation of classical pedagogy.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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